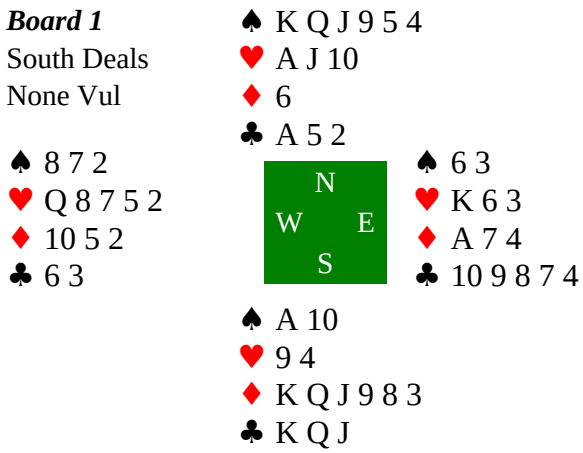
Board 1
South Deals
None Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♠		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♠ by North
Lead: ♥3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♠

Lead the ♥3.

The ♣10 would probably be a very safe lead. But you don't want "safe", you want "attack".

Dummy has advertised a long, strong ♦ suit which declarer will no doubt establish for discards.

It is important for your side to create a winner before your ♦A is forced out. The most likely looking winner is your ♥K. So lead the small ♥ and hope partner has the Queen.

Board 2
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 7 6 2
♥ A 6 3
♦ K 4
♣ Q J 5

♠ 4
♥ 10 9 8 4
♦ 8 6 3 2
♣ K 8 7 2

♠ K Q J 10 8
♥ 7 5 2
♦ A 5
♣ 9 6 3

♠ 5 3
♥ K Q J
♦ Q J 10 9 7
♣ A 10 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Dbl	
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♠4.

If partner had not doubled the contract you would probably have started with the ♥10, or possibly the ♣2.

But partner DID double, and most good players play that doubling 3NT is lead-directing as follows:If you have bid a suit, lead it. If doubler has bid a suit, lead it. If neither of you has bid, lead dummy's first bid suit.

So lead a ♠, certainly not a lead you would have made without the double. Partner immediately establishes 4 ♠ winners and he has the ♦A for an entry.

With any other lead declarer will make the contract.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ K Q 7
♥ K 10 9 8
♦ A K 5
♣ 10 9 2

♠ 5 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 8 4 2
♣ A K Q 7 4

♠ J 10 9 3
♥ 4 2
♦ J 10 9 6 3
♣ 8 5

♠ A 8 6 4
♥ A J 6 5
♦ Q 7
♣ J 6 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Dbl	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			

4♥ by North
Lead: ♣8

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♥

Lead the ♣8.

If partner had not doubled South's Stayman 2♣ bid you would probably have started with one of your Jacks.

But partner **DID** double, and the double of a conventional bid clearly means that the doubler would like you to lead that suit.

So lead a ♣, and partner will take three ♣ tricks. With any other lead declarer would quickly discard a ♣ from dummy on a high ♦, easily making the contract.

Declarer may still make the contract if he guesses the ♥Q correctly, but maybe not.

Board 4
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ K J 5 ♥ A 9 8 5 3 ♦ K Q ♣ A Q 5	
♠ 9 7 2 ♥ Q J 10 6 ♦ 10 7 6 2 ♣ 7 3		♠ 10 8 6 4 ♥ 7 2 ♦ J 9 3 ♣ J 10 9 8
	♠ A Q 3 ♥ K 4 ♦ A 8 5 4 ♣ K 6 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			

6NT by South
Lead: ♦2

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♦2, or perhaps the ♠9. Admittedly the ♥Q looks very tempting, but resist the temptation.

Since dummy bid ♥s, don't help declarer by leading the suit. Declarer has 11 tricks, and will hope to pick up one more in ♣s, but that won't happen.

But if you start with the ♥Q, he will win with his ♥K and can then establish an extra ♥ winner by leading through your ♥ J 10 into dummy's ♥ A 9.

With any lead other than a ♥ honor he cannot come to 12 tricks.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ K J 9 6 3 ♥ A 6 ♦ K 9 ♣ Q 10 8 5	
♠ 7 4 2 ♥ 9 8 7 2 ♦ Q J 6 4 2 ♣ 3		♠ A ♥ Q J 10 3 ♦ 8 7 5 3 ♣ A 7 4 2
	♠ Q 10 8 5 ♥ K 5 4 ♦ A 10 ♣ K J 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	2♣
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♠
Pass	Pass	Dbl	
All Pass			

4♠X by North
Lead: ♣A

That's why you doubled.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♠

Did you choose the ♥Q? I was afraid you would. That is wrong, but because this is the last Deal I'm going to give you another chance.

Look at the bidding carefully, then ask yourself why you doubled.

Now pick the opening lead that will set the contract, then

Lead the ♣A, then follow with a small ♣.

South/North apparently have 8 or more ♣s between them, which leaves partner with a singleton at most.

Partner will ruff the second ♣, and when you get into the lead with the Ace of trumps you will play a third ♣ which he will again ruff.